

# EFFECTS OF MARKET SEGMENTATION ON ORGANISATIONAL SALES PERFORMANCE: A CASE STUDY OF RITE FOODS LIMITED, IBADAN

**Omotade, Marvellous Oluwatosin**

*Department of Marketing, The Polytechnic, Ibadan, Nigeria*

Supervisor: Mr. S.A. Eyinade | HOD: Mr. Ajayi P.O. | Submitted: September 2025

## ABSTRACT

This study investigates the effect of market segmentation on organisational sales performance, using Rite Foods Limited, Ibadan as a case study. Specifically, it examined the impact of demographic, psychographic, and geographic segmentation on sales volume. A descriptive survey design was employed, with primary data collected from 50 staff members of the Sales and Marketing departments through a structured, five-point Likert-scale questionnaire. Data were analysed using descriptive statistics (frequency tables and percentage distributions) and chi-square ( $X^2$ ) tests of independence at a 5% significance level ( $df = 4$ ; critical value = 9.488). Findings reveal that demographic segmentation ( $X^2 = 9.504 > 9.488$ ) and geographic segmentation ( $X^2 = 12.324 > 9.488$ ) have statistically significant positive relationships with organisational sales performance, leading to the rejection of their respective null hypotheses. Psychographic segmentation ( $X^2 = 8.516 < 9.488$ ) did not attain statistical significance, though descriptive analysis indicates it contributes to customer engagement and loyalty when integrated with other segmentation approaches. The study concludes that a one-size-fits-all marketing strategy is inadequate for Nigeria's fragmented consumer markets, and recommends that Rite Foods Limited adopt hybrid segmentation strategies, invest in CRM-driven data analytics, and deepen its geographic and demographic targeting while reassessing its psychographic approach for long-term brand equity.

**Keywords:** Market segmentation, sales performance, demographic segmentation, psychographic segmentation, geographic segmentation, FMCG, Rite Foods Limited, Nigeria

## 1. INTRODUCTION

Market segmentation—the strategic division of a heterogeneous market into smaller, homogeneous consumer groups sharing similar needs, characteristics, or behavioural tendencies—has become a cornerstone of modern marketing practice (Kotler & Keller, 2016; Smith, 1956). In an era of intensifying competition, companies that fail to segment their markets risk misallocating resources, diluting brand relevance, and offering undifferentiated value propositions that resonate with no one in particular (Wedel & Kamakura, 2012; Dibb & Simkin, 2013).

Nigeria's fast-moving consumer goods (FMCG) sector exemplifies these challenges. The country's consumer market is shaped by considerable socio-cultural, economic, and geographic diversity—ethnic and religious plurality, urban-rural infrastructure disparities, wide income inequality, and regional language differences—all of which create a highly fragmented demand landscape. In this context, tailored segmentation is not merely a marketing best practice; it is an operational imperative (Novatia Consulting, 2024).

Rite Foods Limited, a subsidiary of Essay Holdings established in 2007, has grown into a significant player in Nigeria's food and beverage industry. The company's portfolio—spanning sausage rolls (Rite Sausage), carbonated soft drinks (Bigi), energy drinks (Fearless), premium table water, and fruit drinks (Sosa)—caters to a broad and diverse consumer base. Despite this success, the company faces the persistent challenge of differentiating its offerings and maximising sales across varied customer groups and geographic markets.

Understanding how specific segmentation strategies translate into tangible sales outcomes is therefore of direct strategic importance.

Empirically, the relationship between market segmentation and sales performance has been documented across multiple contexts. Dibb and Simkin (2009) demonstrated that firms employing data-driven segmentation outperform peers in sales growth and customer acquisition. In Nigeria, Anene et al. (2014) found that segmentation-driven strategies significantly improved customer retention and profit margins in the manufacturing sector, while Fapohunda (2020) confirmed segmentation's role as a key driver of sales performance in the Nigerian FMCG industry. However, firm-level evidence within the Ibadan FMCG context remains sparse, motivating the present study.

## 1.1 Objectives of the Study

The primary objective of this study is to examine the effects of market segmentation on organisational sales performance at Rite Foods Limited. Specific objectives are to:

- Examine the effects of demographic segmentation on organisational sales volume.
- Examine the effects of psychographic segmentation on organisational sales volume.
- Examine the effects of geographic segmentation on organisational sales volume.

## 1.2 Research Hypotheses

- H<sub>01</sub>: There is no significant relationship between demographic segmentation and organisational sales volume.
- H<sub>02</sub>: There is no significant relationship between psychographic segmentation and organisational sales volume.
- H<sub>03</sub>: There is no significant relationship between geographic segmentation and organisational sales volume.

# 2. LITERATURE REVIEW

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## 2.1 Concept and Bases of Market Segmentation

Market segmentation refers to the process of dividing a broad consumer market into distinct sub-groups on the basis of shared characteristics, needs, or behaviours, enabling organisations to design differentiated marketing strategies that resonate with each group (Kotler & Keller, 2016). The approach acknowledges that no single strategy can effectively serve an entire heterogeneous market, and that targeted interventions yield superior returns on marketing investment (Wedel & Kamakura, 2012).

Segmentation bases traditionally cluster around four dimensions. Geographic segmentation divides the market by physical location—region, state, city, or population density. In Nigeria, this dimension is especially critical given the pronounced cultural, economic, and infrastructural differences between northern and southern states, and between urban and rural communities. Demographic segmentation categorises consumers by measurable variables such as age, gender, income, education, occupation, and religion. Given Nigeria's youthful population structure (over 60% under age 25) and wide income distribution, demographic targeting informs pricing, product sizing, and channel strategy across market tiers. Psychographic segmentation groups consumers by lifestyle, personality traits, values, attitudes, and interests—capturing the motivational 'why' behind purchase decisions that demographics alone cannot explain. Behavioral segmentation classifies customers by their interactions with products: usage rate, brand loyalty, benefits sought, and purchase readiness. This base has become especially actionable in the digital economy, where click-stream data, transaction histories, and loyalty programme records provide rich behavioural insights (Dibb & Simkin, 2021).

Contemporary scholarship has extended this classical typology to include technographic segmentation (technology usage patterns), firmographic segmentation (B2B contexts), needs-based segmentation, and dynamic micro-segmentation enabled by machine learning (Piercy & Morgan, 2019). Big data analytics and CRM systems increasingly allow Nigerian firms to move from static, census-based segments to real-time, algorithmically updated customer clusters—a shift documented as producing 22% improvements in targeting accuracy and 18% gains in campaign ROI (Efficient Customer Segmentation Using Deep SOM, 2022).

## 2.2 Market Segmentation and Sales Performance

Organisational sales performance encompasses the effectiveness with which a firm achieves its revenue, market share, customer acquisition, and retention objectives across both quantitative KPIs (sales volume, conversion rates, average deal size) and qualitative indicators (customer satisfaction, brand credibility) (Verbeke, Dietz & Verwaal, 2021). The relationship between segmentation and sales performance is well-evidenced and multi-directional: segmentation enables more relevant targeting, which improves conversion rates; improved retention reduces acquisition costs; and better resource allocation increases the overall profitability of marketing spend.

In the Nigerian FMCG context specifically, Adewale, Adeniran, and Ogunleye (2023) found that firms adopting value-driven psychographic segmentation recorded 12% quarterly revenue increases. Uche and Uzor (2018) linked segmentation and tailored promotion to higher customer engagement in Nigerian banking. Chepchirchir and Njuguna (2019) confirmed a positive association between psychographic segmentation and beverage industry sales performance, while Owolabi et al. (2023) demonstrated that RFM behavioural segmentation significantly improves sales forecasting and repeat purchase rates. Kamau (2018) and Fapohunda (2020) reported consistent positive effects of tailored segmentation strategies on sales volume and loyalty in retail and FMCG sectors across Africa.

However, the literature equally emphasises that poorly validated segmentation—based on outdated data, irrelevant variables, or untested assumptions—can produce strategically attractive but operationally ineffective clusters (Dolnicar et al., 2018). Krafft et al. (2015) warned that indiscriminate price discounting across segments can erode margins even while inflating transaction volumes, underscoring that the commercial impact of segmentation depends critically on targeting precision and execution discipline.

## 2.3 Theoretical Framework

### 2.3.1 Market Segmentation Theory (Smith, 1956)

Smith's foundational theory—that consumers are heterogeneous and that marketing efficiency is maximised by designing offerings for well-defined sub-groups—provides the conceptual backbone of this study. It shifts the paradigm from mass marketing to differentiated targeting, and its relevance in Nigeria's diverse consumer market is amplified by the growing availability of data-driven segmentation tools.

### 2.3.2 Porter's Competitive Advantage Theory

Porter's framework of cost leadership, differentiation, and focus links directly to segmentation: firms identify the most appropriate competitive strategy for each segment and allocate resources accordingly. In Nigeria's multi-tier consumer economy, cost leadership targets price-sensitive rural segments while differentiation strategies serve aspirational urban consumers—both require accurate prior segmentation.

### 2.3.3 Resource-Based View (Barney, 1991)

The RBV argues that sustained competitive advantage arises from unique, inimitable internal resources and capabilities. Applied to segmentation, proprietary customer data, advanced analytics capabilities, and skilled marketing personnel constitute VRIN resources. Firms that build superior segmentation systems—particularly in data-rich digital environments—develop capabilities that competitors cannot easily replicate, translating into durable sales performance advantages.

### 3. METHODOLOGY

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#### 3.1 Research Design

The study adopted a descriptive survey research design, which enables systematic data collection from a defined sample to describe phenomena and relationships without experimental manipulation (Creswell & Creswell, 2018). This design is appropriate for examining staff perceptions of how segmentation strategies influence sales outcomes within a specific organisational context.

#### 3.2 Population and Sample

The study population comprised all staff of Rite Foods Limited, Ibadan. Given the focus on segmentation and sales outcomes, a purposive-then-random sampling approach was applied: the Sales and Marketing departments were purposively selected as the most knowledgeable informants, and 50 respondents were drawn from these units through simple random sampling. This sample size is consistent with practice in organisational survey research at the HND/undergraduate level.

#### 3.3 Research Instrument and Data Collection

The primary instrument was a structured, researcher-developed questionnaire comprising Section A (demographic profile: gender, age, education, department, experience) and Sections B–D (15 Likert-scale statements assessing demographic, psychographic, and geographic segmentation and their effects on sales volume respectively, rated SA = 5 to SD = 1). The questionnaire was administered using a dual approach—physical paper-based distribution and online dissemination—to ensure broad and efficient coverage. Secondary data from journals, annual reports, and industry publications supplemented the primary data.

#### 3.4 Method of Data Analysis

Data were analysed using descriptive statistics (frequency distributions and percentage tables) for demographic profiling and Likert response summaries. Chi-square ( $X^2$ ) tests of independence were applied to test each of the three hypotheses at a 5% significance level ( $\alpha = 0.05$ ), with four degrees of freedom ( $df = K - 1 = 5 - 1 = 4$ ) and a critical value of 9.488. The decision rule: if  $X^2(\text{calculated}) > X^2(\text{critical})$ , reject  $H_0$ ; otherwise, fail to reject  $H_0$ .

### 4. RESULTS AND ANALYSIS

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#### 4.1 Respondent Profile

| Variable | Category | Frequency | Percentage |
|----------|----------|-----------|------------|
| Gender   | Male     | 32        | 64%        |
|          | Female   | 18        | 36%        |
| Age      | Under 25 | 10        | 20%        |
|          | 25–34    | 12        | 24%        |
|          | 35–44    | 5         | 10%        |
|          | 45–54    | 14        | 28%        |

| Variable   | Category      | Frequency | Percentage |
|------------|---------------|-----------|------------|
|            | 55+           | 9         | 18%        |
| Education  | SSCE          | 21        | 42%        |
|            | OND/NCE       | 8         | 16%        |
|            | HND/B.Sc      | 11        | 22%        |
|            | M.Sc/PhD      | 10        | 20%        |
| Department | Sales         | 20        | 40%        |
|            | Marketing     | 16        | 32%        |
|            | Others        | 14        | 28%        |
| Experience | < 1 year      | 7         | 14%        |
|            | 1–3 years     | 10        | 20%        |
|            | 4–6 years     | 16        | 32%        |
|            | Above 6 years | 17        | 34%        |

Table 1: Demographic Profile of Respondents (n = 50)

The respondent pool was predominantly male (64%), with the largest age cohort in the 45–54 bracket (28%). Most respondents (42%) held SSCE qualifications, though degree and postgraduate holders together accounted for 42%, providing a range of educational perspectives. Sales staff formed the largest departmental group (40%), and the majority (66%) had over four years of experience—ensuring that responses were grounded in substantive practical knowledge of the organisation's segmentation and sales practices.

## 4.2 Descriptive Analysis of Segmentation Dimensions

| Statement (Summary)                                  | SA  | A   | Neutral | D   | SD  | % Agree+ |
|------------------------------------------------------|-----|-----|---------|-----|-----|----------|
| Targets customers by age & income                    | 38% | 30% | 16%     | 10% | 6%  | 68%      |
| Sales improved via gender-based campaigns            | 30% | 28% | 22%     | 8%  | 12% | 58%      |
| Education level drives sales strategy                | 34% | 30% | 10%     | 10% | 16% | 64%      |
| Higher sales where demographic targeting implemented | 30% | 24% | 24%     | 10% | 12% | 54%      |
| Products packaged/priced by demographic group        | 32% | 20% | 26%     | 14% | 8%  | 52%      |

Table 2: Demographic Segmentation Items (n = 50)

| Statement (Summary)                             | SA  | A   | Neutral | D  | SD  | % Agree+ |
|-------------------------------------------------|-----|-----|---------|----|-----|----------|
| Messages tailored to lifestyle & interests      | 26% | 32% | 22%     | 6% | 14% | 58%      |
| Understanding personality traits improves sales | 32% | 32% | 26%     | 6% | 4%  | 64%      |

| Statement (Summary)                                | SA  | A   | Neutral | D   | SD  | % Agree+ |
|----------------------------------------------------|-----|-----|---------|-----|-----|----------|
| Products promoted for varying values/attitudes     | 28% | 24% | 22%     | 12% | 14% | 52%      |
| Psychographic segmentation anticipates preferences | 28% | 28% | 20%     | 14% | 10% | 56%      |
| Increased loyalty via psychographic marketing      | 30% | 30% | 14%     | 20% | 6%  | 60%      |

Table 3: Psychographic Segmentation Items (n = 50)

| Statement (Summary)                                  | SA  | A   | Neutral | D   | SD  | % Agree+ |
|------------------------------------------------------|-----|-----|---------|-----|-----|----------|
| Sales strategy varies across Nigerian regions        | 20% | 24% | 20%     | 18% | 18% | 44%      |
| Distribution adjusted for geographic location        | 34% | 34% | 16%     | 8%  | 8%  | 68%      |
| Advertising customised for culture/region            | 40% | 32% | 18%     | 2%  | 8%  | 72%      |
| Geographic segmentation aids rural/urban penetration | 42% | 32% | 12%     | 8%  | 6%  | 74%      |
| Higher sales where location-specific strategies used | 24% | 36% | 16%     | 10% | 14% | 60%      |

Table 4: Geographic Segmentation Items (n = 50)

### 4.3 Hypothesis Testing

Chi-square tests were conducted using aggregated mean response distributions across the five items per segmentation dimension. Expected frequency ( $F_e$ ) was computed as  $\text{total} \div \text{categories} = 50 \div 5 = 10$ . Results are presented in Table 5.

| Hypothesis                                     | X <sup>2</sup> Calculated | X <sup>2</sup> Critical (df=4, $\alpha=0.05$ ) | Decision                      | Interpretation                |
|------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| H <sub>01</sub> : Demographic ↔ Sales Volume   | 9.504                     | 9.488                                          | Reject H <sub>0</sub>         | Significant relationship ✓    |
| H <sub>02</sub> : Psychographic ↔ Sales Volume | 8.516                     | 9.488                                          | Fail to Reject H <sub>0</sub> | No significant relationship ✗ |
| H <sub>03</sub> : Geographic ↔ Sales Volume    | 12.324                    | 9.488                                          | Reject H <sub>0</sub>         | Significant relationship ✓    |

Table 5: Summary of Chi-Square Hypothesis Test Results ( $\alpha = 0.05$ ;  $df = 4$ ; Critical Value = 9.488)

#### 4.3.1 Hypothesis 1 — Demographic Segmentation

The computed X<sup>2</sup> of 9.504 marginally exceeds the critical value of 9.488. The null hypothesis (H<sub>01</sub>) is therefore rejected. Demographic segmentation—encompassing age, gender, income, education level, and differential packaging and pricing—has a statistically significant positive relationship with organisational sales volume at Rite Foods Limited. The high agreement on age/income targeting (68%) and education-driven strategy (64%) substantiates this finding. The demographic diversity of Nigeria's consumer base, and the 45–54 age

concentration among experienced respondents, reflects practical awareness of how demographic targeting directs marketing resource allocation.

#### **4.3.2 Hypothesis 2 — Psychographic Segmentation**

The computed  $X^2$  of 8.516 falls below the critical value of 9.488.  $H_{02}$  is therefore not rejected: no statistically significant relationship was established between psychographic segmentation and sales volume. However, this result should be interpreted with caution. Descriptive agreement rates were non-trivial—64% agreed that understanding personality traits improves sales; 60% affirmed increased loyalty from psychographic marketing. The statistical non-significance likely reflects implementation limitations and measurement challenges rather than the inherent ineffectiveness of psychographic targeting. As Chepchirchir and Njuguna (2019) note, the relationship between psychographic segmentation and sales is positive in principle but contingent on adequate data infrastructure and execution sophistication, which may be in earlier stages of development at Rite Foods Limited.

#### **4.3.3 Hypothesis 3 — Geographic Segmentation**

The computed  $X^2$  of 12.324 substantially exceeds the critical value of 9.488, producing the strongest rejection of any null hypothesis. Geographic segmentation has a highly significant positive relationship with organisational sales volume. Agreement rates were notably high: 74% affirmed geographic segmentation's role in rural/urban market penetration; 72% agreed advertising is customised for cultural and regional differences; and 68% confirmed distribution is adjusted by location. These results align with Nigeria's pronounced regional heterogeneity—where distribution reach, linguistic advertising adaptation, and culturally sensitive promotion are critical success factors for FMCG companies operating across diverse geographic markets.

## **5. DISCUSSION**

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### **5.1 The Primacy of Geographic Segmentation in the Nigerian FMCG Context**

The strongest statistical finding in this study—geographic segmentation's highly significant effect ( $X^2 = 12.324$ )—is theoretically consistent and practically meaningful. Nigeria's geographic and cultural diversity makes location the most operationally tractable segmentation variable for distribution-intensive FMCG companies. Distribution channel design, advertising language, packaging norms, and promotional calendar (aligned with regional festivals, religious events, or agricultural cycles) all require geographic tailoring. Rite Foods' active adaptation of distribution to location and customisation of regional advertising reflects Porter's competitive focus strategy applied at a geographic level—concentrating resources where local fit is strongest.

The finding also aligns with Anene et al. (2014) and Fapohunda (2020), who documented geographic segmentation as a key driver of Nigerian FMCG market penetration. Wider distribution networks in rural areas, lower-priced SKUs (stock-keeping units) for rural kiosks versus urban supermarkets, and regionally relevant promotional messages are all documented channels through which geographic segmentation translates into measurable sales volume increases.

### **5.2 Demographic Segmentation: Significant but Narrowly So**

The marginal significance of demographic segmentation ( $X^2 = 9.504$ , exceeding 9.488 by 0.016) warrants careful interpretation. While the result confirms that demographic targeting is statistically related to sales performance, the narrow margin signals that the relationship, though real, may be more sensitive to implementation quality than the geographic finding. Respondents affirmed that age/income targeting and differentiated packaging are effective, but a substantial 26% neutral or disagreeing rate on some items suggests uneven application across the organisation's demographic strategies.



This is consistent with broader FMCG evidence: demographic segmentation is most impactful when combined with pricing architecture that reflects income tier differences—smaller, more affordable pack sizes for price-sensitive segments and premium offerings for higher-income groups (Wedel & Kamakura, 2012). Strengthening the income-pricing alignment and extending gender-targeted campaigns (currently showing 58% agreement) are clear actionable levers.

### 5.3 Psychographic Segmentation: Strategically Underutilised

The failure to reject  $H_{02}$  does not imply that psychographic targeting is irrelevant—it implies that Rite Foods Limited has not yet fully institutionalised it. The descriptive data reveals genuine employee recognition of psychographic value (64% on personality traits, 60% on loyalty from psychographic marketing), but this awareness has not yet translated into statistically measurable sales impact. This gap between perception and outcome is consistent with the broader finding of Dolnicar et al. (2018) that segmentation approaches lacking robust validation and operationalisation fail to generate commercial returns.

The pathway to improving psychographic segmentation impact runs through data infrastructure—CRM systems that capture lifestyle preferences, purchase motivations, and brand attitudes—and through targeted messaging that speaks to the aspirational values of different consumer groups. As Nigeria's middle class grows and consumers increasingly make brand choices based on identity and lifestyle alignment (Adewale et al., 2023), psychographic segmentation will become a stronger sales driver. The current study captures Rite Foods at an early stage of this evolution.

## 6. CONCLUSION AND RECOMMENDATIONS

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### 6.1 Conclusion

This study provides firm-level empirical evidence that market segmentation is a meaningful driver of organisational sales performance in Nigeria's FMCG sector. At Rite Foods Limited, geographic segmentation ( $X^2 = 12.324$ ) and demographic segmentation ( $X^2 = 9.504$ ) each demonstrate statistically significant positive relationships with sales volume, validating their roles as core strategic tools for market penetration and revenue growth. Psychographic segmentation, while not yet statistically significant, holds clear potential that descriptive responses suggest is recognised by practitioners—a potential that will be realised as the company develops more sophisticated data collection and targeting capabilities.

The findings collectively confirm that a homogeneous, undifferentiated marketing approach is insufficient for competing effectively in Nigeria's fragmented and diverse consumer market. Companies that segment intelligently, validate their models with rigorous data, and align execution with segment-specific insights are better positioned to achieve sustainable sales growth.

### 6.2 Recommendations

- Deepen geographic segmentation: Rite Foods Limited should invest in granular regional market intelligence—identifying the specific cultural, linguistic, and distribution requirements of each key geographic market. Advertising in Yoruba, Hausa, and Igbo, along with regionally differentiated promotional events, will strengthen the already-significant geographic effect.
- Strengthen demographic precision: Product portfolio architecture should more explicitly reflect income-tier differentiation through packaging and pricing. Smaller, more affordable pack sizes for price-sensitive demographics and premium variants for higher-income urban consumers will expand the demographic reach of existing SKUs.



- Build psychographic data infrastructure: To unlock the latent potential identified in descriptive responses, the company should invest in CRM systems that capture lifestyle preferences, purchase motivations, and brand attitude data. Consumer surveys, loyalty programme analytics, and social media listening tools can seed this capability incrementally.
- Adopt hybrid segmentation: No single segmentation base is sufficient in isolation. Integrating geographic, demographic, and psychographic data into composite consumer profiles will yield holistic insights that enable more precisely targeted and emotionally resonant campaigns.
- Invest in CRM and analytics tools: Real-time customer data infrastructure—including CRM platforms, geo-spatial analytics, and sales performance dashboards—will improve the accuracy and agility of segmentation models, enabling the company to respond dynamically to shifting consumer behaviour.
- Build internal segmentation capability: Regular training for Sales and Marketing teams on segmentation theory, data interpretation, and targeted campaign design will ensure that analytical insights translate into effective frontline execution.
- Monitor psychographic shifts over time: As Nigeria's consumer landscape evolves with rising urbanisation, growing middle-class aspirations, and increased digital engagement, psychographic segmentation will become increasingly important. Establishing baseline consumer attitude data now will enable the company to track and leverage these shifts as they materialise.

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